

13 YEAR TOPPERS

LAW

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2010	NLSIU, Bangalore	NALSAR, Hyderabad	NLIU, Bhopal
2009	NLSIU, Bangalore	NALSAR, Hyderabad	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi
2008	NALSAR, Hyderabad	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi
2007	NLSIU, Bangalore	NALSAR, Hyderabad	NLIU, Bhopal
2006	NLSIU, Bangalore	NALSAR, Hyderabad	NLIU, Bhopal
2005	ILS, Pune	NLSIU, Bangalore	Symbiosis Law College, Pune
2004	NLSIU, Bangalore	UCL, Bangalore	ILS, Pune
2003	NLSIU, Bangalore	Govt. College of Law, Mumbai	Faculty of Law, BHU, Varanasi
2002	NLSIU, Bangalore	ILS, Pune	Govt. College of Law, Mumbai
2001	NLSIU, Bangalore	UCL, Bangalore	Govt. College of Law, Mumbai
2000	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi	Law College, Pune
1999	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi	Law College, Pune
1998	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi	Law College, Pune

ENGINEERING

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2010	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Chennai
2009	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur
2008	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai
2007	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Chennai
2006	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai
2005	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Chennai
2004	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Mumbai
2003	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai
2002	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur	BITS, Pilani
2001	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur	BITS, Pilani, IIT, Chennai, Delhi, Mumbai
2000	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Chennai	IIT, Delhi
1999	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Delhi
1998	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Delhi

MEDICINE

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2010	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2009	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2008	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2007	AIIMS, Delhi	AFMC, Pune	CMC, Vellore
2006	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2005	AIIMS, Delhi	AFMC, Pune	SJMC, Bangalore
2004	AIIMS, Delhi	BMC, Bangalore	KMC, Manipal
2003	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2002	CMC, Vellore	AIIMS, Delhi	JIPMER, Puducherry
2001	AIIMS, Delhi	AFMC, Pune	LHMC, Delhi
2000	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
1999	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	JIPMER, Puducherry
1998	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	JIPMER, Puducherry

Reverend Felix Raj says, "The education system should have practical training beyond the regular classroom."

At the Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS), Pilani, Rajasthan, a task force called Vision 2020 has been set up, its plan being to make BITS a leading institution in the world. G. Raghurama, director of BITS, says the plan involves international collaboration, "to invest heavily in modern infrastructure to let our faculty engage in research as needed by industry and government agencies."

To keep pace with the demand for an increase in its Gross National Product, India will have to double its Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) in education. In real terms that means doubling the available seats. Even though only 12.4 students in a 100 currently enter higher education, the ratio for seats is monumental. Over 4.5 lakh entrants sat for the joint entrance exam for 9,500 engineering seats in the IITs, Institute of Technology, Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi, and Indian School of Mines, Dhanbad. For the liberal arts courses, Delhi University sold over 1.8 lakh applications for its 54,000 seats. Loyola College, Chennai, has about 20,000 applicants for its 2,100 seats.

Human Resource Development Minister Kapil Sibal wants India's GER raised so that 30 students in 100 can leave school and enter college for a degree, be it vocational, professional or liberal arts and pure sciences. He was quoted as saying it meant India needed 600 more universities and 35,000 more colleges in the next 12 years. Even if these numbers may seem grossly exaggerated, what India's needs now is expansion of a basic quality of college education.

It could come from the elite deciding to expand centres in new cities, driven by their philosophy of excellence and high standards. The arrival of foreign universities may stir the pot, but as Sanjib Ghosh, principal, Presidency College, Kolkata, says that should only happen "with less commercialisation and exploitation". The current rash in private education offers both a solution and a challenge. India's leading colleges remain non-profit organisations, whose emphasis is on their students, not on bottom-lines. Our college toppers, in fact, provide the blueprint for what an ideal education is all about.

with Amarnath K. Menon, Sarbani Sen,

Diksha Madhok, Nandini Vaish and Rohit Parihar